Pathway 1 – Public Sector Employed Trainees, Apprentices and Graduates

Skilling SA Public Sector

Pathway 1 of *Skilling SA Public Sector Project* provides for the recruitment, employment and training of new trainees, apprentices and graduates by public sector agencies. To confirm eligibility and recruitment processes under this project, please use the guide below.

CANDIDATE ELIGIBILITY

Traineeship or Apprenticeship

An eligible candidate will:

- Be aged between 17 and older[1]
- Be an Australian Citizen, Permanent Resident or have an appropriate work visa
- Have not completed a traineeship within the South Australian Public Sector previously, or one hosted by the South Australian Public Sector
- Not currently be a South Australian Public Sector employee
- If previously a South Australian Public Sector employee who accepted a TVSP, will not be eligible to be re-employed in the South Australian Public Sector (agencies should check via the Eligibility for Re-employment Register) for a period coinciding with the number of weeks of the payment to them as part of the TVSP unless the individual repays to the Crown a sum equivalent to the remuneration paid to them upon the termination of their employment by resignation.

Graduate Program

An eligible graduate candidate for the Project will:

- Have attained a university qualification within the last three years or will attain one before their employment commences.
- Have a registered Contract of Training as part of their Graduate training program.
- Be an Australian Citizen, Permanent Resident or have an appropriate work visa
- Have completed a qualification as per the requirement of the agency graduate program which will specify the relevant discipline and whether post graduate qualifications are considered
- If previously a South Australian Public Sector employee who accepted a TVSP, will not be eligible to be re-employed in the South Australian Public Sector (agencies should check via the Eligibility for Re-employment Register) a period coinciding with the number of weeks of the payment to them as part of the TVSP unless the individual repays to the Crown a sum equivalent to the remuneration paid to them upon the termination of their employment by resignation.

[1] Applies to trainees only, no age criteria for apprentices.

Candidate responsibilities
A trainee, apprentice or graduate candidate must:

- be willing to complete a pre-employment declaration
- be willing to undertake a National Police Check or other appropriate background screening where required by an agency
- participate in assessment of literacy and numeracy ability if required to demonstrate suitability for job pre-requisites.
- undertake vocational qualification training requirements of the project
- undertake training and professional development activities scheduled as per contract of training and training plan.
- meet all other employment and participation conditions of the project including travelling independently to and from the workplace, training sites and other sites as determined.
- uphold the Public Sector Values and adhere to the South Australian Public Sector Code of Ethics.

QUALIFICATION ELIGIBILITY

A qualification for the traineeship, apprenticeship or graduate placement will be eligible under the Project if it satisfies the following criteria:

1. The qualification must be at the Certificate III, Certificate IV, Diploma or Advanced Diploma level.
   - Qualification specific entry requirements are located here. Use the Quick Search function on the right to find the qualification and click on it in the search results to display details.
2. The qualification is on the Traineeship and Apprenticeship Pathways Schedule (TAPS). This list includes all qualifications that can be completed under a Contract of Training.
3. The qualification is on the Subsidised Traineeship and Apprenticeship List (STAL), which contains a list of the courses that may be subsidised in South Australia:
   - Click here for the latest list of qualifications that the Department for Innovation and Skills (DIS) will subsidise through a Contract of Training.
   - While it is not essential for an identified qualification to be on the STAL, if the qualification is not on the list it may result in an agency paying a higher training fee.

Identifying a nationally accredited training provider to deliver the qualification

1. The chosen training provider must be able to deliver the qualification under a Contract of Training.
2. If you do not have a preferred training provider, you can use the Subsidised Course Provider Search to check which training provider deliver the qualification at a subsidised rate under a Contract of Training in South Australia.
3. When choosing a training provider it is advisable to look at how the training is delivered and the amount of time an employee is expected to commit. In offering a traineeship, apprenticeship or graduate program placement your agency agrees to support the employee's participation in face-to-face and/or online training and associated study in paid work time.

4. Contact the training provider to obtain a quote and training duration details for the qualification under a Contract of Training and explore potential course commencement dates.

Confirming agency is registered as an employer with DIS

1. It is a requirement under the *South Australian Skills Act 2008* (SAS Act) that an employer is registered with DIS to employ trainees and apprentices (including graduates undertaking training under a Contract of Training). You can confirm your agency's registration status online.
2. To register, renew or make changes to your registration, visit skills.sa.gov.au.
3. Registration must include the scope of the relevant vocation, the corresponding qualification and the worksite location of the employee before a Contract of Training can be established to allow training commencement.
4. For further details, please refer to the 'Employer Registration with DIS' information sheet.

RECRUITMENT, APPOINTMENT AND EMPLOYMENT COMMENCEMENT

Once the agency has identified the trainee/apprentice/graduate vacancy, the corresponding qualification and chosen training provider they can complete an application to the Office of the Commissioner of Public Sector Employment (OCPSE) to recruit and appoint an apprentice/trainee or graduate under the *Skilling SA Public Sector Project*, using the following steps:

I APPLY

1. If the candidate and qualification criteria listed above is met, the agency will then lodge an I APPLY form to advise OCPSE of intent to recruit independently or to utilise Group Training Organisation (GTO) panel recruitment services.
   Note – if an appointment has already been made at the time of lodgement, please specify this in the I APPLY form in the relevant field.
2. OCPSE will review the I APPLY submission and respond to the agency to confirm project eligibility and funding, and to assist with referral if GTO recruitment services are required.

Recruitment and appointment

1. If the agency has elected to recruit the candidate independently, standard agency recruitment process are followed, ensuring that candidate eligibility criteria listed above are taken into consideration.
2. If the agency has elected to use the GTO Panel recruitment service, OCPSE will coordinate for the GTO to recruit in accordance with the position and agency requirements, to identify suitable candidates for the agency to consider. This service is available to all agencies participating in the *Skilling SA Public Sector Project* at no cost.
3. Once an appropriate candidate is selected, they are appointed through regular agency HR processes.

Employment Commencement

1. Upon commencement of their employment, the agency provides the new trainee, apprentice or graduate an agency-related induction, while OCPSE provides a Public Sector induction.
2. OCPSE will assign the trainee, apprentice or graduate to a mentor group to enhance their peer and support networks.
3. OCPSE will also provide training for the supervisor of the new trainees, apprentices and graduates to enhance their knowledge of the Project, legal and industrial requirements, supervision considerations, and training and assessment under a Contract of Training.

Training commencement

1. Once the trainee, apprentice or graduate candidate has been recruited the agency will liaise with an Australian Apprenticeship Support Network (AASN) provider to establish a Contract of Training for the new employee.

   The two AASN providers in South Australia are:

   - MAS National – Phone: 1300 627 628
   - MEGT – Phone: 136 348

   When the Contract of Training is lodged with DIS for approval this will trigger notification to the training provider to accept the training nomination and develop the training plan. It is recommended that once an agency has confirmed who they are going use as their training provider they make them aware a Contract of Training is being signed so that preliminary discussions can take place prior to the training provider being notified by DIS.

2. Please note that commencement of training with the training provider will normally not commence until the Contract of Training is approved.

OCPSE SUPPORT

Case Management

OCPSE Skilling SA team monitor trainees, apprentices and graduates progress through check in surveys at regular intervals.

Agencies are encouraged to contact their OCPSE Skilling SA Senior Employment Consultant should any issues arise.

Job Seeker Training

OCPSE will arrange workshops and invite trainees, apprentices and graduates towards the end of their Contract of Training, to provide job seeker training and support.

For enquiries please contact: OCPSESkillingSA@sa.gov.au.